

✱ Fixed Start and End Sequencing:

→ In this exercise, sentences S1 and S4 of a four-sentence paragraph are given, while S2 and S3 are missing. Depending on the format, you must either select the correct pair of sentences for S2 and S3 from four jumbled options (P, Q, R, S) and identify their order, or decide the correct order of two given sentences (P, Q) to fill S2 and S3. Read S1 and S4 carefully to understand how the paragraph begins and ends, then choose the sentences that best connect them by following the logical flow of ideas, cause-and-effect relationships, or narrative sequence, so that all four sentences together form a smooth, coherent paragraph.

1. **S1: The Amazon rainforest is often called the "lungs of the Earth" due to its vast capacity to absorb carbon dioxide.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: Scientists warn that continued destruction could push the rainforest past a point of no return within decades.

Options for P and Q:

P: However, illegal logging and agricultural expansion have destroyed nearly a fifth of its original coverage.

Q: This loss of forest cover directly threatens the region's ability to regulate rainfall and store carbon.

1. S2 = Q, S3 = P

2. S2 = P, S3 = Q

2. **S1: In the early 2000s, streaming services began quietly reshaping how people consumed entertainment.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: Traditional television networks were forced to rethink their entire business models to survive.

Options for P and Q:

P: As internet speeds improved, more households abandoned cable subscriptions for on-demand content.

Q: This shift gave viewers unprecedented control over what, when, and how they watched shows.

1. S2=P, S3=Q

2. S2=Q, S3=P

3. **S1: Honeybees play a critical role in pollinating nearly a third of the food crops humans consume.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: Without urgent intervention, global food security could face serious long-term consequences.

Options for P and Q:

P: This decline is largely attributed to pesticide use, habitat loss, and climate change.

Q: In recent years, however, bee populations worldwide have been declining at an alarming rate.

1. S2=Q, S3=P

2. S2=P, S3=Q

4. **S1: The invention of the printing press in the fifteenth century transformed the spread of knowledge across Europe.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: Within decades, literacy rates began climbing steadily among the growing middle class.

Options for P and Q:

P: Books that once took months to copy by hand could now be produced in a fraction of the time.

Q: This dramatic drop in cost made written material accessible to people beyond the clergy and nobility.

1. S2=P, S3=Q

2. S2=Q, S3=P

5. **S1: Renewable energy sources like solar and wind are increasingly competing with fossil fuels on cost.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: Analysts now predict that renewables could account for the majority of new power capacity by the next decade.

Options for P and Q:

P: Government subsidies and falling technology costs have accelerated this shift considerably.

Q: As a result, several countries have already begun phasing out coal-fired power plants entirely.

1. S2=Q, S3=P

2. S2=P, S3=Q

6. **S1: A young potter in a small Gujarat village once shaped a clay lamp so fine that it was said to never crack, no matter how hot the flame within it.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: From then on, he refused to sell it, keeping it instead on his own windowsill through every season.

Options for P, Q, R and S:

P: Merchants travelled from distant towns offering him gold coins, but he turned every one of them away.

Q: He had made it, he later admitted, for no buyer in particular, simply to see if it could be done.

R: Word of the lamp spread quickly, and soon merchants began arriving at his door with offers.

S: Their persistence only convinced him further that the lamp was not meant to be bought or sold.

1. QR

2. QS

3. PS

4. RP

7. **S1: In an old Sri Lankan legend, a fisherman's daughter was said to sing so sweetly that the sea itself grew calm to listen.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: Fearing she might one day sing herself away from them entirely, her parents made her promise never to sing near open water again.

Options for P, Q, R and S:

P: One evening she sang from the shore, and the fishing boats, without a single hand on their oars, drifted safely home through a storm.

Q: Sailors from neighbouring villages began arriving simply to anchor near her home and listen at dusk.

R: News of the strange, calming song reached her parents, who grew uneasy at the attention it drew.

S: She agreed at once, though she found it hard, in later years, to pass the shore without humming under her breath.

1. PQ

2. PR
3. QR
4. RQ

8. **S1: A schoolteacher in a hill town kept a register of every student who had ever passed through her single-room classroom, going back forty years.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: She simply smiled and said she had never really needed the register at all, only the habit of keeping it.

Options for P, Q, R and S:

P: When a fire finally destroyed the schoolhouse, the register was the only object she rushed back inside to save.

Q: Former students, hearing of the fire, wrote to ask how she had managed to recall each of their names so easily afterward.

R: Neighbours who watched her run back in assumed she valued it above every other possession she owned.

S: To their surprise, she answered each letter by hand, without once consulting the singed pages she had saved.

1. PR
2. RQ
3. QS
4. PQ

9. **S1: A retired railway signalman spent his evenings building a miniature model of every station he had worked at over three decades.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: He never displayed the finished models publicly, keeping them instead in a locked room his grandchildren were rarely allowed to enter.

Options for P, Q, R and S:

P: Each tiny platform, signal box, and footbridge was rebuilt from memory, down to the paint that had long since faded from the originals.

Q: A local museum curator, hearing of the collection, asked to exhibit it as a record of a vanishing railway era.

R: He turned down the request politely, saying the stations belonged only to the years he had actually spent in them.

S: Visitors who glimpsed the room by accident often mistook the models for professionally manufactured replicas.

1. PQ
2. SP
3. QR
4. PS

10. **S1: During a severe drought in central India, a farmer dug a well on his land purely on the advice of a wandering water diviner he had never met before.**

S2: _____

S3: _____

S4: Even after the well ran dry two summers later, he refused to fill it in, insisting it had earned its place in the field.

Options for P, Q, R and S:

P: Neighbours mocked him at first, certain the stranger's forked stick was nothing more than theatre.

Q: Water struck at barely twelve feet, far shallower than any of the professionally surveyed wells nearby.

R: Their mockery quietened considerably once the digging began to yield results faster than anyone expected.

S: The diviner had simply walked the field once, paused near a cluster of dry babool trees, and pointed.

1. PR
2. SQ
3. QP
4. RS

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Answer: 2. S2 = P, S3 = Q

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Answer: 1. S2=P, S3=Q

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S: Their persistence only convinced him further that the lamp was not meant to be bought or sold.

1. QR

2. QS

3. PS

4. RP

Answer: 4. RP

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S: She agreed at once, though she found it hard, in later years, to pass the shore without humming under her breath.

1. PQ
2. PR
3. QR
4. RQ

Answer: 3. QR

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1. PR
2. RQ
3. QS
4. PQ

Answer: 2. RQ

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1. PQ
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4. PS

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1. PR

2. SQ

3. QP

4. RS

Answer: 1. PR